Motivation Theories

Unit 1 · 1.3.4.4 Managing people

Motivation is the drive that makes employees work hard and well. Four classic theories explain it differently.

Taylor — Scientific Management

Workers are motivated mainly by **money**. Break jobs into simple tasks, train workers, and pay by output (**piece-rate**). Efficient, but treats people mechanically and can cause boredom.

Mayo — Human Relations

The Hawthorne studies showed workers are motivated by **social needs and attention**: team working, communication and manager involvement — not just pay.

Maslow — Hierarchy of Needs

- Physiological (pay for food, shelter)
- Safety (job security, safe conditions)
- Social (teamwork, belonging)
- Esteem (recognition, respect)
- Self-actualisation (challenge, growth)

A worker is only motivated by the next level up once the one below is met, so firms offer different incentives to move staff up the hierarchy.

Herzberg — Two-Factor Theory

Motivators (achievement, recognition, responsibility) come from the job itself and drive effort; **hygiene factors** (pay, conditions, security) only prevent dissatisfaction. Herzberg saw **pay as a hygiene factor** — the opposite of Taylor.